

BANKHAUL · CALCULATION

BankHaul sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	First sizing note at TRL 3 for the constructable design (BKH-DDR-002)

BankHaul sizing calculations

The constructable design meets nine of the eleven requirements on paper. R8 (cost per station) is not met, at USD 382 against the target, and R5 (far stake holding) is met in soft mud but at risk in very soft mud. Every figure below is produced by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` from the parameters in `cad/src/model.py`; `docs/04-calcs/results.csv` holds the results table. Values marked "estimate" are first-order and are checked by test at TRL 4.

Safety: These calculations size a rope system that works under load beside crocodile water. They are first-order and are not a substitute for proof-load tests on the anchors, stake, rope splices and weak links before the station is used.

■ Results against requirements

Table 1. Results against every requirement

ID	Target	Result	Status	Section
R1	Set and haul with nobody in the water	No step needs anyone in the water once the far stake is set from a boat	Met on paper; field trial at TRL 4	J
R2	At least 30 m between pulleys; stretch 50 m	30 m design case; rope bought for 50 m	Met on paper	A
R3	Peak pull under 250 N	200 N (estimate)	Met on paper	B
R4	Holds 3 kN in soft wet soil without movement	Anchor factor 2.13 at 10 kPa	Met on paper; pull test at TRL 4	D
R5	Holds 1.5 kN horizontal in soft mud	Factor 2.46 at 10 kPa; 1.23 at 5 kPa	Met in soft mud; at risk in very soft mud	E
R6	Full haul and reset under 10 min	6.3 min (estimate, without clearing fish)	Met on paper (estimate)	G
R7	One season without rope or pulley failure	Rope factor 5.7 after sun damage	Met on paper (estimate)	F
R8	Parts under USD 80 per station	USD 382	Not met	I
R9	Relocated by two people in under 30 min	22 min (estimate)	Met on paper (estimate)	H
R10	Weak link releases 500 to 700 N	510 to 690 N	Met on paper; calibrate at TRL 4	C
R11	Working spot at least 5 m from the water	5.0 m	Met by layout	J

■ A. Loop and rope

Assumptions: 12 mm floating polypropylene and polyethylene blend rope ("polysteel"), 20 kN minimum breaking strength, 0.068 kg/m, density about 0.93; blocks with 100 mm sheaves, so the rope centre runs on a 56 mm radius.

- Loop length for the 30 m design span: $2 \times 30 + 2 \times \pi \times 0.056 = \mathbf{60.4 \text{ m}}$; for the 50 m stretch span, 100.4 m.
- Rope bought: 120 m, cut into two halves of 55 m (each 5 m longer than the 50 m span for splices and knots), leaving 10 m spare. The surplus of each half is coiled at its ring, which never passes a block.
- The loop for 30 m weighs 4.1 kg and floats.
- Sheave to rope diameter ratio: $100 / 12 = \mathbf{8.3}$, at the usual minimum of 8 for fibre rope.

■ B. Hand pull to haul a 30 m net with catch (R3), estimate

Assumptions: a 30 m by 2 m gillnet with a 0.06 kg/m lead line, 1.2 kg of twine and a 0.03 kg/m float line; the wet net is 1.6 times its dry mass; 10 kg of catch and 5 kg of weed or debris; friction 0.6 on the bed and the wet bank; hauling at 0.4 m/s; the bank edge rises 0.5 m over 1 m (27 degrees); the fisher stacks the net on the table as it arrives, so about a fifth of the net is on the bank edge at once.

Load	Value	Basis
Lead line friction on the bed	9.7 N	Submerged weight of the lead line x 0.6
Drag of the bunched net and catch	40.0 N	$0.5 \times 1,000 \times 0.4^2 \times 0.5 \text{ m}^2$
Catch, weed and a fifth of the net up the bank edge	156.8 N	$15.9 \text{ kg} \times 9.81 \times (0.6 \cos 27^\circ + \sin 27^\circ)$
Loop following round both blocks	18.3 N	Rope friction on the ground, block efficiency 0.95 each
Peak hand pull	200 N	Bank edge load, half the water loads, loop

The peak comes at the instant the whole catch is on the bank edge. Hauling is done by the net's near end, so the loop only follows. Setting the net takes about **43 N** at 0.5 m/s.

■ C. Weak link (R10) and design loads

The weak link sets the largest load a seized or snagged net can put into the system.

- Release: nominal **600 N**, plus or minus 15 % (510 to 690 N). The cord is chosen by pulling three samples from the batch bought.
- The largest load in normal use is during setting, **62 N**, so the lowest release is **8.3 times** the normal load: no nuisance breaks.
- Far end design load: both legs at the highest release, **1.38 kN**, within the 1.5 kN of R5.
- Bank design load: **3.0 kN** (R4) horizontal at the near block. It covers twice the link release, debris on the loop and a jammed cleat.

■ D. Bank post, stays and screw anchors (R4)

Assumptions: soft wet soil with an undrained shear strength of 10 kPa; anchors with a single 250 mm helix on a 1.6 m rod, set in line with the stay; capacity $Q = F_c \times s_u \times A$ with $F_c = 9$ for a deep helix (depth to helix diameter 3.6, at the critical depth for this soil).

Quantity	Value	Note
Stay length, lug hole to anchor eye	1.44 m	Anchor eyes 1,100 mm behind and 450 mm either side
Stay elevation	38.7°	
Stay tension at 3 kN	2,076 N each	Both stays share the pull along the line
Stay rope factor	9.0	10 mm polyester, 22 kN, 85 % at the eye splice
Post compression	2,595 N	Buckling factor 93 (48.3 x 3.2 tube, 1.0 m, pinned)
Foot plate bearing	22.6 kPa	Factor 2.3 on 5.14 x su
Helix depth	0.89 m	
Anchor capacity	4,418 N each	Factor 2.13 on the stay tension
Pad eye shear	33.6 MPa	Block load 6 kN, two shear planes
Block working load factor	1.67	500 kg block, two legs at 1.5 kN

A factor of 2 or more on the anchor's ultimate capacity is taken as "no visible movement", since helical anchors creep noticeably above about half their ultimate load. R4 is met on paper; the TRL 4 pull test on a CalRig-style rig settles it.

■ E. Far stake lateral capacity (R5)

Method: Broms' short free-head pile in cohesive soil. The load acts 1.2 m above the bed (1.0 m of water plus 0.2 m to the far block). The stake is a 76.1 x 3.6 mm S355 tube embedded 2.5 m.

Bed	Undrained shear strength	Ultimate lateral load	Factor on 1.5 kN	Bending stress at 1.5 kN
Soft mud	10 kPa	3,689 N	2.46	150 MPa (factor 2.4 on S355)
Very soft mud	5 kPa	1,845 N	1.23	162 MPa (factor 2.2 on S355)

A 60.3 mm stake would carry 3.0 kN in soft mud but reach about 250 MPa at 1.5 kN, too close to yield; the 76.1 mm tube was chosen for strength (BKH-DDR-002, item 6). R5 is met in soft mud and **at risk in very soft mud**. Options worked out for Amish (factor on 1.5 kN in very soft mud): embedding 3.0 m, **1.62**; embedding 3.5 m, **2.03**; two stakes 1 m apart tied at the top, **2.21**. The decision is in `docs/REVIEW.md`, Decisions for Amish.

■ F. Loop rope strength and durability (R7)

- The largest leg tension is the larger of the link's highest release and half the bank load: 1.5 kN. The new rope through a splice (85 %) has a factor of **11.3** on it.
- Assuming the rope loses half its strength to sun over a tropical season, the factor at the end of the season is **5.7**.
- Two set and haul cycles a day for 180 days give about 720 passes over each sheave, far below the bending fatigue life of fibre rope at a sheave ratio of 8.
- Blocks with bushed nylon sheaves in silty water are the less certain part; the season pilot at TRL 4 records bush wear.

R7 is met on paper as an estimate.

■ G. Cycle time (R6), estimate

Haul at 0.25 m/s with stacking (2.0 min), unclip (1.0 min), re-clip (1.0 min), set 30 m at 0.4 m/s (1.3 min), cleat and tie off (1.0 min): **6.3 minutes**. Clearing a 10 kg catch of about 30 fish at 20 s each takes a further 10 minutes, as it does today; the loop does not change it, so it is outside this figure.

■ H. Relocation (R9), estimate

Two people: unscrew both anchors (4 min), lift out the post and spike (2), carry up to 50 m (3), set out the new spot (3), screw in both anchors (6), stand the post and tension the stays (4): **22 minutes**. Re-tying both ring knots for the new loop length takes about 6 minutes more and is outside R9, which covers the bank anchor.

■ I. Cost per station (R8) and value engineering

The station parts in `bom/bom.csv` cost **USD 382**; with the stake driving cap, the prototype costs USD 392. Value-engineering target: USD 1,800. Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 392 (USD 1,408 under the target).

The largest cost drivers are the two screw anchors (USD 76), the rope (USD 54), the far stake (USD 48), the two blocks (USD 44), the table (USD 35) and the post (USD 32). Two options were costed for Amish:

- One bank post and table serving three loops at a landing site: about **USD 257** per loop.
- A local-materials station (hardwood post with bolted fittings, buried timber deadman, hardwood far pole, two hand-made hardwood sheaves on steel pins, rope for a 30 m span only, galvanised rings, hardwood cleats, a pole table): about **USD 98**.

R8 is not met. The decision is in `docs/REVIEW.md`, Decisions for Amish.

■ J. Layout and masses

- The post stands 6 m back from the water's edge and the fisher works within 1 m of it: **5.0 m** from the water (R11).
- Once the far stake is set from a boat or at low water, setting, hauling, clearing and relocating the bank station are all done from the bank (R1).
- Masses: bank post weldment 17.2 kg, far stake 26.8 kg, two screw anchors 14.3 kg, clearing table 26.4 kg, swivel collar 1.6 kg, two blocks 2.2 kg, rope 7.5 kg, small parts about 4 kg: about **100 kg** for the station. The heaviest part is the far stake, handled by two people from a boat.